AI OPERATIONS · MATURITY FRAMEWORK

The AI Operations Maturity Model

Where AI actually stands in your operations: not which tools you have bought, but how decisions, ownership and execution work.

Most organizations measure AI maturity by counting tools: which platforms are licensed, which pilots are live, which team has a chatbot. That is a poor measure. The organizations that get real value from AI are not the ones with the most tools. They are the ones where AI is tied to a clear owner, a measurable outcome and a repeatable workflow.

We assess maturity across 4 stages. Most organizations sit lower than they expect, not because the technology is missing, but because the operating structure around it has not caught up.

1 Fragmented

The default starting point

AI shows up in pockets. Teams and individuals adopt tools on their own, with no shared standard, no accountable owner and no link to a business outcome.

- Different teams use different tools for similar tasks, with no one coordinating
- No one could say who is accountable if an AI-assisted decision goes wrong
- Leadership hears about AI use anecdotally, not through any reporting line

2 Emerging

Structure starts to form

Some functions have a defined approach, but it has not spread. Systems and data are fragmented enough that scaling what works is hard.

- One or two functions have a real workflow; the rest are still improvising
- Data lives in disconnected systems, so nothing scales cleanly
- Wins exist but stay local and do not transfer to other teams

3 Aligned

Consistent, but not everywhere

AI is applied consistently within functions and tied to a business metric. It is not cross-functional yet, and governance is still informal.

- Each function can point to a metric AI is actually moving
- Adoption is consistent within teams, but coordination across teams is ad hoc
- Basic guardrails exist, with no organization-wide review process

4 Optimized

The operating standard

AI is embedded across the organization, with named ownership, real governance and a visible line to business performance that changes what leaders decide.

- Leaders get signal that changes decisions, not just more dashboards
- Defined risk controls and reviews cover AI use organization-wide
- A new AI use case can be absorbed without re-arguing ownership each time

What determines your stage: 6 dimensions

1. Operational alignment
2. Ownership and accountability
3. Data and systems integration
4. Revenue and efficiency linkage
5. Leadership visibility
6. Governance and risk controls

Want to know your organization's actual stage?

The AI Operations Maturity Scorecard is a paid assessment that rates all 6 dimensions individually, places you in one of the 4 stages and points to the gaps to address first. We walk your leadership team through the results.

ilene.ai/scorecard

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